



County Council, March 31st, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=A4KMWkFB2cQ
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: March 31, 2026

Body: Delaware County Council

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order on March 31, 2026, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Buckhout, Mr. Flangan, Mr. Mogul, Mr. Piper, Mr. Wyatt, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Freeman
 - **Absent:** Mr. Cans (out of town on business)
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Hughes (Council President, implied by duties)

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Jessica.
- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved by roll call vote.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Consideration of the February 24th Council meeting minutes was tabled by a roll call vote as the minutes were not yet ready.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:04 Court Appropriations (County General)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth (Auditor's office) / Ted Ward (Court Administrator)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed a previously tabled request from Judge Calhoun regarding appropriations for either a full-time administrative assistant (\$40,000) or part-time position (\$25,520), plus benefits (totaling \$75,386). Newly appointed Court Administrator Ted Ward noted he was still getting familiar with the role in his second day on the job. Council members agreed to keep the matter on the table to allow Mr. Ward time to evaluate office priorities and structure.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Remained on the table (no removal motion made).
- **00:06:11 Major Transfer Outside County General (Sales Disclosure Fund to Reassessment)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Terry Cheatham, Chief Deputy Assessor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A major transfer from the 1131 Sales Disclosure Fund to the 1224 Reassessment fund (\$20,400 for postage and freight for notice of assessments; \$1,869 for rental lease equipment/copier fee; total \$22,269).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:08:12 Appropriation Outside County General (Sales Disclosure Fund)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Terry Cheatham, Chief Deputy Assessor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Associated appropriation for the sales disclosure fund totaling \$29,269 (including professional services, contractual services, postage/freight, and equipment rental).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:09:06 Opioid Grant Appropriation (Fund 8199)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda, Community Corrections
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Yearly opioid grant shared with adult probation for peer recovery, supplies, professional, and contractual services, totaling \$60,000 (first installment of three).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:10:39 Juvenile Community Corrections Grant Appropriation (Fund 8195)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda (filling in for Jeff Hanser, Chief Probation Officer)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Yearly Juvenile Community Corrections Grant covering probation officer salary, benefits, and professional services through June 30th, totaling \$31,250.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:12:05 Surveyor's Cornerstone Perpetuation Fund Appropriation (Fund 1202)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tom Borchers, Delaware County Surveyor's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual appropriation of \$40,000 for contractual services with Ashton Land Surveyors to update historical records, tie sheets, and GIS data on the county website.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:15:13 Re-Approval of January and February Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth (Auditor's office) / Council
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The auditor explained a new state requirement mandating that appropriations be advertised directly to Gateway 14 days prior rather than solely through the newspaper. Because of this administrative change, the council needed to re-approve previously enacted January and February appropriations across multiple funds (totaling over \$2.1 million combined across categories).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **02:14:25 Amended Meeting Schedule**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's office / Council
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adoption of an amended meeting schedule to adjust filing deadlines so the county can meet the new state Gateway advertising requirements for appropriations. Meeting dates themselves remain unchanged.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **03:21:57** Presiding officer and council checked for public comment both in-person and online; none were presented.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements & Reports:**
 - **Treasurer Brad Hope (00:19:39, 03:00:00):** Provided an update on the negative hiatus/encumbrance issue from the previous month, stating offices are still reviewing bookkeeper records and hope to present a resolution soon. Later announced that tax statements are officially in the mail, noting overall collections are up by over \$130 million (roughly \$4<U+2013>6 million more than last year due to state assessment increases).
 - **Sheriff Tony Skinner (02:22:58):** Presented his annual year-end review. Highlights included a pension fund increase to \$25.5 million (an 11.35% investment return), jail out-of-county billing and federal inmate housing generating nearly \$1.7 million in 2025 (\$5.2 million total over 5 years), 11,878 hours of deputy training, and an 82%

jail capacity status supported heavily by pre-trial probation and home detention programs.

- **Coroner Gavin Green (02:29:53):** Reported 189 calls year-to-date (averaging 63 per month) and 42 autopsies/medical reviews.
- **Council Announcements:** Council members reminded residents to watch out for slow-moving farm vehicles as farming season begins. Council also recognized young man Hayden DeLong for receiving the Sheriff's Office Citizen Heroism Award for bravery and quick thinking.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following a motion by Jessica and a second by Dan.

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